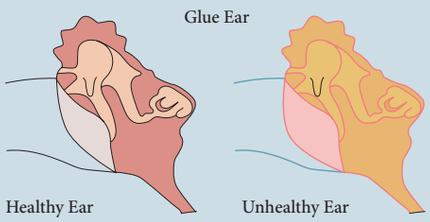
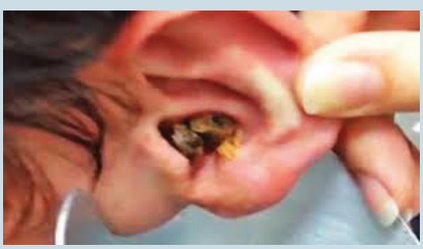
The nurse should be sensitive to any behavioral cues that might indicate a hearing impairment. When caring for patients with the hearing aid, the nurse instructs the patients on proper cleansing and maintenance as well as communication techniques, that promotes hearing.

- Anatomy of the ears: (Refer Lesson 2)

5.8.2 Common ear problems

Ear problems	Image	Symtoms and treatment
1. ***Otitis media:*** inflammation of the middle ear which causes a build-up of fluid, with or without an infection. If there is an infection, it is often viral. Many children will have several bouts of otitis media before they are 7 years old.		• Symptoms include crying, ear pulling, mild fever and irritability. • Antibiotic ear drops.
2. ***Glue ear:*** a type of chronic otitis media. A long-term build-up of thick or sticky fluid in the middle ear behind the eardrum causes hearing loss.		• This can make socialising and learning difficult, especially if hearing loss is not recognised in early childhood.
3. ***Ear wax:*** protects the ear and is normal. However, a build-up of wax may be a problem in some adults, and may require wax-softening ear drops.		• Impacted ear wax rarely causes an ear discharge or pain, but it may cause hearing impairment. • Sometimes the ears may also need to be syringed • and cleaned by a doctor.

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